

Evidence and Sources

Project: Transparent Book Recommender

1. Your mission

Your learning target

I can explain the mechanism and terminology of claim support and citation evaluation.

I can apply the stated procedure to a new case with a traceable result.

I can identify an assumption or limitation and design a revealing follow-up.

Remember before reading

Close your notes first. A rough first answer helps us choose the right starting point; it is not a score for your ability.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Prompt Experiments. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Image and Voice Pipelines. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Recommendation Scores. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

After trying, check the relevant lesson or ask your teacher. Change the part of your explanation that the evidence shows was wrong.

Week 29: Evidence and Sources

Claims require sources matched to the question and checked independently.



THINKER MISSION

Verify a generated answer using two suitable sources.

Thinker name and date:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Readiness for the connected explanation

Recall Building a grounded answer. Explain why a recorded result needs its input conditions and evidence source before it can support a claim.

This week's end goal

By the end, I can separate citation presence, link validity and support for an exact claim.

2. Notice the evidence

PICTURE STORY

Notice → Predict → Explain

Begin with visible evidence. Do not explain more than the picture and information support.



MYSTERY

The learners must use evidence and sources to solve a problem. What information do they have? What decision or calculation do they make? What would count as evidence that it worked?

Three observations (what you can point to):

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

My prediction and the clue supporting it:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

A closer explanation

Citation evaluation checks source existence, exact passage support and coverage of answer claims. A real citation can still be irrelevant.

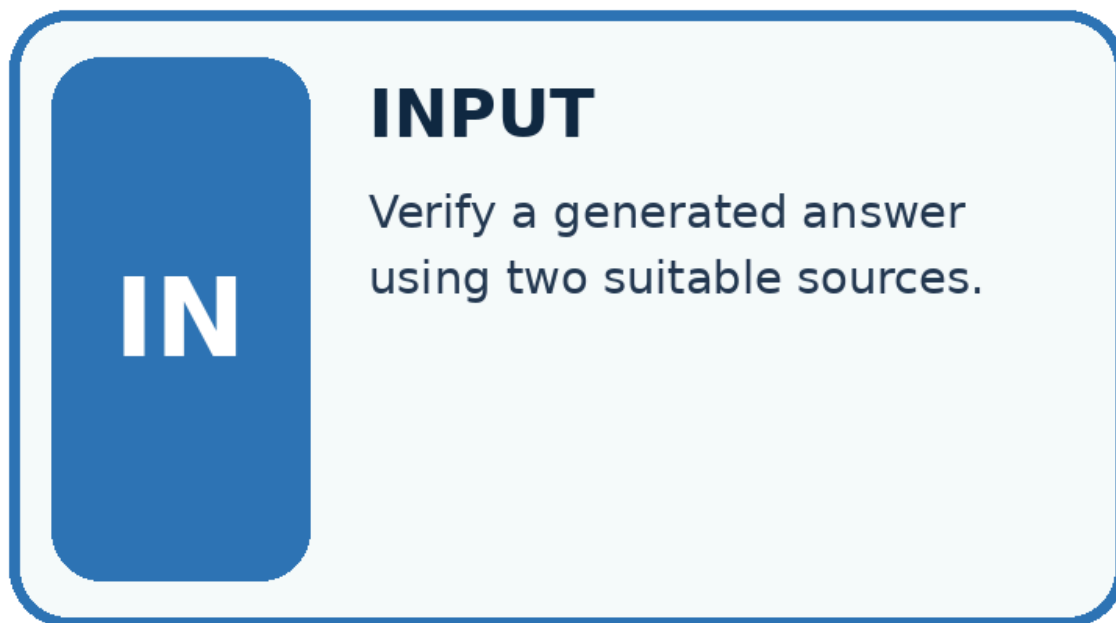
Begin by writing the question the procedure is intended to answer. Identify the information already supplied, the information it will produce and the information still missing. These are constructed classroom examples; they do not require live accounts, private records or an external service. Do not treat a plausible explanation as a measured outcome.

3. See how it works

VISUAL MECHANISM

Input → Process → Output

Trace the information. At each stage, ask what changed and how you could test it.



↓



PROCESS

Claims require sources matched to the question and checked independently.



OUT

OUTPUT

Verify a generated answer using two suitable sources.

Which stage could fail even when the other two are correct? Explain:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

A closer explanation

For this classroom rubric count a claim as supported only when its cited passage entails it. Separately count correct citation links. Use the number of factual claims as the support denominator.

Claim support and citation evaluation — evidence trace

Input and scope · Check or calculation · Conclusion and limit

Input and scope: An answer has four factual claims. Three have citations, but only two are supported by their cited passages. All links exist.

Check or calculation: For this classroom rubric count a claim as supported only when its cited passage entails it.

Conclusion and limit: Claim support is $2/4=50\%$; citation presence is $3/4=75\%$; link existence among three citations is $3/3$. These measure different failures.

The figure connects this chapter's worked input, declared procedure and result. Read the complete worked reasoning for qualifiers and intermediate steps; the abbreviated labels do not replace that reasoning.

Before applying the procedure, write its units, denominator or decision boundary where relevant. A partner should be able to repeat each step using the same inputs. If a required input is absent or violates the stated contract, record that condition explicitly instead of quietly replacing it with a convenient value.

Connect the picture and the explanation

Point to the input, the deciding step and the result in this week's visual. Explain the same step in ordinary words. A picture helps when you can say what each part represents.

4. Compare the cases

CASE GALLERY

Four Tests, Four Kinds of Evidence

A system is not understood until it survives more than one comfortable example.



NORMAL
Expected everyday case



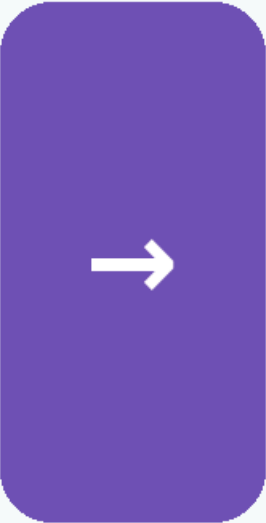
BOUNDARY
Near a decision edge

NORMAL CASE: predict and name evidence. BOUNDARY CASE: predict and name evidence.



MISSING

Needed information absent



TRANSFER

Fresh situation or user

MISSING INFORMATION: predict and name evidence. TRANSFER CASE: predict and name evidence.

Which case is most likely to reveal a hidden assumption? Why?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Change the third claim to “the record does not assess suitability”.

Prediction: That statement accurately describes the supplied record’s limits.

Reason: R gives pages and shelf only; it contains no suitability assessment.

5. Words that unlock the idea

VOCABULARY LAB

Words You Can Use to Reason

A definition matters when you can recognize the idea, use it, and contrast it with a near-miss.



2

SOURCE

where evidence comes from

3

INDEPENDENT

not copied from the same
origin

4

CORROBORATE

support a claim with
another source

Word · My own example · Not this / boundary

Word: claim

My own example: A statement that can be examined using evidence and reasoning.

Not this / boundary: _____

Word: source

My own example: The record, person or material from which information is obtained.

Not this / boundary: _____

Word: independent

My own example: Produced or assessed without the specific influence being excluded; state whether this means uncoached work or separate test data.

Not this / boundary: _____

Word: corroborate

My own example: Support a claim with additional relevant evidence, ideally independent of the first source.

Not this / boundary: _____

Words used in the closer explanation

Word · Meaning

Word: Entailment

Meaning: Whether the cited passage supports the specific claim

Word: Citation coverage

Meaning: Which claims include source references

Word: Link validity

Meaning: Whether a source reference resolves to the intended record

6. Follow a worked example

WORKED EVIDENCE

Reason Step by Step

Predict first. Then check each step. A correct answer without visible reasoning is incomplete evidence.

WEEK 29 • WORKED EVIDENCE

- 1 Claim: a book won an award in 2024.
- 2 Find the award organization's record and the publisher's page.
- 3 Check exact title, year, edition, and whether sources are independent.
- 4 If evidence conflicts or is absent, mark 'not verified' rather than guess.

1. Claim: a book won an award in 2024.
2. Find the award organization's record and the publisher's page.
3. Check exact title, year, edition, and whether sources are independent.

4. If evidence conflicts or is absent, mark 'not verified' rather than guess.

Recalculate, retrace, or restate the reasoning in your own representation:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

CHECK Did the evidence answer the exact question? Did the total, path, or source record stay consistent?

A closer explanation

An answer has four factual claims. Three have citations, but only two are supported by their cited passages. All links exist.

Claim support is $2/4=50\%$; citation presence is $3/4=75\%$; link existence among three citations is $3/3$. These measure different failures.

Compare the intermediate evidence with the final statement. Explain why each number or decision follows from the stated inputs. The conclusion belongs to this scenario and procedure; changing the inputs, evaluation population or authority can change what it establishes. Retain the raw record so a later revision can be compared honestly.

Learn from the worked case

Cover the result before checking it. Say what is given, choose the procedure, and follow one step at a time. Then uncover the result and explain your first mismatch. Ask why a step is allowed, not only what number it produces.

A pictorial worked case: Evidence and Sources

A fictional catalogue answer contains three factual statements and cites existing records.

The facts we will use

Record R: book Ocean Maps has 80 pages and is available on shelf 2.

Claims: 80 pages [R]; shelf 2 [R]; suitable for every child [R]. All three citations resolve to R.

Different citation checks

percent



Bar length shows the supplied value; the marked baseline is zero.

Evidence and Sources

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Break into claims

Count three factual claims rather than treating the answer as one blob.



2. Check links

All three citation links resolve to the intended R.



3. Check exact source support

R supports page count and shelf, not universal suitability.



4. Report separately

Citation presence 3/3; link validity 3/3; supported claims 2/3.

CHANGE ONE THING

Change the third claim to "the record does not assess suitability".

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Break into claims

What happens and why: Count three factual claims rather than treating the answer as one blob.

Step: 2. Check links

What happens and why: All three citation links resolve to the intended R.

Step: 3. Check exact source support

What happens and why: R supports page count and shelf, not universal suitability.

Step: 4. Report separately

What happens and why: Citation presence 3/3; link validity 3/3; supported claims 2/3.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

An existing citation is not automatically evidence for every nearby sentence. Read the cited passage and compare its exact scope with the claim. The universal suitability statement extends beyond what R says. Remove or qualify unsupported content; adding more copies of the same link does not create the missing evidence.

What this example does not establish

Source support is relative to supplied records; those records can themselves be incomplete, outdated or incorrect.

7. Find and repair a mistake

ERROR DETECTIVE

Compare → Diagnose → Repair

Do not patch the answer. Find the earliest unsupported assumption, wrong step, or weak evidence.



COMPARE • DIAGNOSE

Weak idea: Two websites always count as two independent sources. Strong move: locate evidence, change one cause, and retest.

Evidence record · Expected · Actual · Likely cause / next test

Evidence record: normal case

Expected: works

Actual: _____

Likely cause / next test: _____

Evidence record: boundary case

Expected: stated rule

Actual: _____

Likely cause / next test: _____

Evidence record: missing input

Expected: safe response

Actual: _____

Likely cause / next test: _____

Evidence record: fresh transfer

Expected: generalizes

Actual: _____

Likely cause / next test: _____

Repair one cause. Why is this repair better than changing several things?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

A closer explanation

Complete the supported workbook tasks before attempting W4 independently. Record any hints or help used. After feedback, use the teacher's fresh retry rather than copying the earlier answer. For a project,

select a relevant new case, predict the outcome from the declared rule and preserve the result alongside any revision.

Exit: propose one revealing change to the worked scenario. State the expected outcome and the evidence that would make you revise your explanation.

8. Practise together

LOGIC STUDIO

Trace Before You Run

Block code, pseudocode, tables, and diagrams are different ways to expose the same reasoning.



TRACE THE LOGIC

Predict the result. Trace every condition or calculation. Compare expected with actual. Explain the first difference.

SET evidence_record PREDICT expected_result RUN one normal case and one boundary case
COMPARE actual_result with expected_result IF different: locate first cause; change one factor; RETEST
EXPLAIN result, limitation, and next safe step

Trace one input. Which line changes the state or chooses a path?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

A closer explanation

Citation counts do not establish truth beyond the supplied sources or the correctness of uncited claims.

A useful check asks what would make the reasoning fail. Distinguish a failure to execute the declared procedure from a weakness in the procedure itself. The first may require a correction; the second requires an explicitly revised method and new evidence. Preserve unsuccessful cases so an improved result cannot hide the original problem.

Guided: restate the worked result, then name the assumption or limitation that prevents a broader conclusion.

Practise with less help: Trace the worked case

Use workbook W2 for the connected example “Claim support and citation evaluation”. First fill the input and rule boxes. Try the middle steps before asking for a hint. After a hint, try the next step yourself.

Plan · Do · Check

Plan: What is given? Which rule or procedure applies?

Do: Record each intermediate step.

Check: Does the result follow? What remains unknown?

Explain your trace to a partner. Your partner points to one step to check. Swap roles on the next case. Each person writes their own explanation.

Check your reasoning

Use the worked case for Claim support and citation evaluation. Proposed explanation: “The worked result establishes every future case”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Answer on your own before discussion. If you are unsure, say which step you need help with.

Explain the picture

Why is the original answer not fully supported despite having citations on every claim?

My explanation using a pictured step and the given facts

This is supported practice. Keep the separately named independent case for an attempt before feedback.

9. Run the investigation

EVIDENCE LAB

Predict → Test → Record → Explain

Keep expected and actual results separate. Surprises are useful data when recorded honestly.



PREDICT → TEST → RECORD → EXPLAIN
Highlight checkable claims in an answer, match each to the best source type, record evidence, and label supported / conflicting / unverified.

Highlight checkable claims in an answer, match each to the best source type, record evidence, and label supported / conflicting / unverified.

Test / input · Prediction · Actual · Evidence / calculation · Change or keep?

Test / input: normal

Prediction: _____

Actual: _____

Evidence / calculation: _____

Change or keep?: _____

Test / input: boundary

Prediction: _____

Actual: _____

Evidence / calculation: _____

Change or keep?: _____

Test / input: missing

Prediction: _____

Actual: _____

Evidence / calculation: _____

Change or keep?: _____

Test / input: fresh transfer

Prediction: _____

Actual: _____

Evidence / calculation: _____

Change or keep?: _____

What did the hardest test teach you that the normal test did not?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Plan → try → check

Before trying: what do I expect, and why? While trying: which step could first go wrong? Afterwards: what

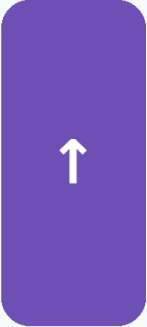
did I actually observe, and what should change? Keep “not run” if you only traced the procedure.

10. Build your understanding

MASTERY

From Knowing the Word to Owning the Idea

Move upward only when you can produce evidence without copying the worked example.



MASTERY LADDER

1 Name it • 2 Trace it • 3 Apply it • 4 Challenge it • 5 Explain limits

- 1 • NAME: Define the concept without repeating the textbook.
- 2 • TRACE: Show the information, state, branch, calculation, or evidence path.
- 3 • APPLY: Solve a different example independently.
- 4 • CHALLENGE: Find a boundary case, counterexample, or unfair outcome.
- 5 • EXPLAIN LIMITS: Say when the result should not be trusted or used alone.

My strongest evidence of independent understanding:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

11. Connect your project

CUMULATIVE PROJECT

Transparent Book Recommender

Every week adds one inspectable piece. The system must show how it reached a result.



TRANSPARENT BOOK RECOMMENDER

Separate profile-based ranking evidence from factual book information and cite the latter.

THIS WEEK’S CHECKPOINT Separate profile-based ranking evidence from factual book information and cite the latter.

SYSTEM MAP Reader need → allowed inputs → transparent rule or score → ranked candidates → explanation → test record → human decision

What will you add, change, or verify in the project this week?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

What should remain under human control?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

RESPONSIBLE DESIGN Collect only necessary information. Show uncertainty and limits. Never confuse a ranking with a fact about a person.

Evidence for your project

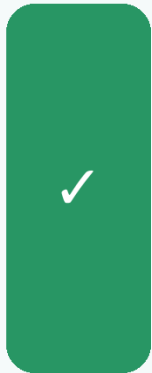
Attach source IDs to recommender explanation facts and separately audit whether each source supports its precise statement.

12. Show what you know

INDEPENDENT MASTERY PROOF

Explain • Transfer • Test • Defend

Complete this page without copying the worked example. Your reasoning matters more than decoration.



INDEPENDENT PROOF

Verify a generated answer using two suitable sources.

CHALLENGE Verify a generated answer using two suitable sources.

1. My fresh example, trace, calculation, or design:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

2. My evidence that it works (include a boundary or missing-data case):

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

3. One limitation, fairness concern, or situation needing human review:

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

SELF-CHECK ☐ I explained the mechanism ☐ I used evidence ☐ I tested a fresh case ☐ I named a limitation ☐ I can answer 'why?'

13. Study a complete case

Week 29 Worked case

Use the supplied details to practise the weekly concept before attempting the independent question. This case extends the illustrated lesson.

The situation

An answer says 80 pages, but the catalogue for that edition says 120.

The question

What evidence guides correction?

Worked explanation

Check the exact edition and authoritative catalogue record. Record the supporting source.

Explain it in your own words

Which detail supports the answer, and why does it matter?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Trace the supplied case visually

Check the claim against the exact edition

Evidence or stage · Value or result

Evidence or stage: Answer

Value or result: 80 pages

Evidence or stage: Catalogue

Value or result: 120 pages for this edition

Evidence or stage: Resolution

Value or result: Verify edition and cite the correct record

An answer says 80 pages, but the catalogue for that edition says 120.

What evidence guides correction?

Check the exact edition and authoritative catalogue record. Record the supporting source.

14. Try a new case independently

Independent case: Apply a new case independently

Five claims; four cited; three supported by cited passages; one cited ID is nonexistent. Compute support and citation presence and explain link limits.

My independent explanation, trace and limits

Attempt this case before feedback. Record any help. Earlier examples below are further practice; a case already practised with feedback cannot establish fresh transfer.

Week 29 Independent application

Close the worked explanation. Apply the idea to this different question without copying.

An answer cites a page about opening hours to support a claim about book prices. Is a citation enough? What must be checked?

My answer, with a trace, calculation or supporting evidence

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Create and test

Change one relevant detail. Predict the result before testing. Include a boundary or missing-information case when it helps reveal a limit.

My changed input and expected result

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Connect to your project

Separate profile-based ranking evidence from factual book information and cite the latter.

The evidence I will keep

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Your teacher has the independent answer and scoring criteria. Complete the matching workbook week to keep your practice evidence together.

Transfer practice from the original programme

Two catalogue records list 96 and 112 pages for a title. A helper averages them and reports 104. Explain the mistake and a better verification process.

Explain the mechanism, evidence and one limit.

Use feedback to improve

Attempt the independent case before hints. Record whether you worked alone, used a hint or followed a model. After feedback, fix the first unsupported step and explain why it changed. A later check uses a changed case, not a copied answer.